Pick Our Path

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 8, Episode 1

Seven finished books stood in the library. The atlas lay open to a blank page beside three invitations: a sunny meadow for a picnic or flower viewing, a broad pine lookout for sketching, and a dry reed-bank platform for sharing a book. Lark made room beside her. This time the purpose and destination belonged to your choice.

“Where shall we go?” Lark asked curiously. “I shall bring the useful things,” Nib promised earnestly.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **gate**

“We can read to choose something we want to do,” Lark explained warmly. “Sun has our short u, pine has long i with final e, and reed has ee. Read the three labels, then connect each one to its offered purpose. None is a better reading answer.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try sun, pine, reed. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Which outing would you like to plan, and what would you like to do there?” Lark asked gently. “You can point, tell us, or use the invitation pictures.”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **The sun is up. The pine is tall. The reed is by the bank.**

“Which sentence connects the reed to a place?” Lark asked gently. “Which invitation fits your own purpose?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Lark entered the selected invitation in the destination space on the atlas draft. The other invitations stayed available for another day. Choosing a route did not claim the crew had visited it yet. Nib set out three more spaces beside it: equipment, stopping place, and a useful condition or alternative.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write your selected route label beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your first atlas journal page would keep the actual route and purpose you selected. A second source waited for each possible outing, ready to add preparation information the cheerful invitation had left out.